



Functional Programming? Haskell?

Functional Programming

```
import Data.Char(toUpper)
```

```
mkWelcome :: (String -> String) -> Int -> Int -> String
```

```
mkWelcome stylize year n = concat
```

```
  [ stylize "Welcome", " to INFOFP in ", show year, "!\n\n"
```

```
  , head teachers, " and me will have to grade ", show (numExams n)
```

```
  , " exams this time .."
```

```
] where numExams m = 2 * m
```

```
capitalize s = map toUpper s
```

```
teachers = [ "Mathijs Vakar", "Frank Staals" ]
```

```
welcomeMsg = mkWelcome capitalize 2026 269
```

```
import Data.Char(toUpper)

mkWelcome :: (String -> String) -> Int -> Int -> String
mkWelcome stylize year n = concat
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  , head teachers, " and me will have to grade ", show (numExams n)
  , " exams this time .."
  ] where numExams m = 2 * m

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teachers = [ "Mathijs Vakar", "Frank Staals" ]

welcomeMsg = mkWelcome capitalize 2026 269

main = putStrLn welcomeMsg
```

WELCOME to INFOFP in 2026!

Mathijs Vakar and me will have to grade 538 exams this time ..

What is Functional Programming?

What is Functional Programming?

- A way of thinking about solving problems:

Define what something *is* rather than *how* to compute it.

Imperative (C#) vs. Functional (Haskell)

```
int sumUpTo(int n) {  
    int total = 0;  
    for (int i = n; n > 0; i--)  
        total += i;  
    return total;  
}
```

sumUpTo 0 = 0

sumUpTo n = n + sumUpTo (n-1)

Our aim is to

Teach you *functional programming* techniques

- Using functions as first-class values
- Separating pure and impure computations
- Reasoning about your programs
- Using strong types
- ...

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- ...

You can write “functional code” in almost any language!

Why Functional Programming?

To create better software

1. Short term: fewer bugs

- *Purity* means fewer surprises when programming
 - A function can no longer mutate a global state
- *Purity* makes it easier to *reason* about programs
 - Reasoning about OO $\implies$ master/PhD course
 - Reasoning about FP $\implies$ this course
- Higher-order functions *remove* lots of *boilerplate*
 - Also, less code to test and fewer edge cases
- *Types* prevent the “stupid” sort
 - What does `True + "1"` mean?

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2. Long term: more maintainable

- Types are *always updated* documentation
- Types help a lot in *refactoring*
 - Change a definition, fix everywhere the compiler tells you there is a problem

How?

Lectures:

- Tuesday, 11.00 to 12.45
- Thursday, 15.15 to 17.00

Instructions !!!!!: Once a week

- Thursday, 13.15 to 15.00

Practicals

- Tuesday, 09.00 to 10.45

Who?

Matthijs Vákár and Frank Staals (me) and in the lectures

- Contact us through email

10 teaching assistants in the labs

1. **Slides** contain most of the content
 - In some cases, supplemented by additional material
2. Pen-and-paper **exercises**
 - There's more than programming in this course
 - Ask questions during instruction sessions
 - Remember: there is *no compiler* at the exam
3. Book: *Programming in Haskell* (2nd edition) by Graham Hutton
 - The course follows it, except for chapters 13 and 17
 - More resources can be found in the website (<https://uuinfofp.github.io/>)

- 'Pen-and-Paper' style exam questions
 - Closed book
 - No compiler
- Remindo-based

Practical assignments

1. The first one helps you getting started
2. Three small ones with PrairieLearn.
3. One bigger project

Practical assignments

- Submissions are **individual**
 - Do not plagiarize!
 - No AI Tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Claude, Copilot, etc)
- Graded automatically : Pass vs Fail
 - correct = Pass, not fully correct = Fail
- You need to pass at least 2 out of 3 Practical Assignments

- Ask TAs for advice during practicals
- Important part of the final project grade

Develop your own **game** in Haskell

- Required to work in **pairs**
- Submission in two parts
 1. Preliminary design document
 2. Code of the project
 3. Required to use git to track progress
 4. Progress meetings with the TAs

Grading

Linear combination of two grades plus bonus

- M = Midterm grade
- F = Final exam grade
- P = Process bonus ≤ 0.4
- R = Result bonus ≤ 0.4
- **Grade** = $\min(0.3M + 0.7F + P + R, 10)$

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Requirements:

- $0.3M + 0.7F \geq 5$
- Pass at least two practical assignments
- Pass the final programming assignment

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- Pass at least two practical assignments
- Pass the final programming assignment

See website for more details.

If you did the course last year

- **Resubmit** your Practical assignments
- Redo the **final project**
 - Using the same code as last year is *not* allowed
- Redo **all** the **exams**

Communication channels

- In person at the Instructions, Practicals, and Lectures
- E-mail
 - Check your UU-mail regularly
- Brightspace
 - As a means to access your grades.

`https://uuinfofp.github.io/`

- All important information is found there
- Schedule, slides, assignments, exercises

Getting Started:

Functional Programming *Features*?

Some distinguishing **features** of FP:

1. Recursion instead of iteration
2. Pattern matching on values
3. Expressions instead of statements
4. Functions as first-class citizens

Try it!

1. Go to <https://play.haskell.org>
2. Write your definitions on the left pane

```
sumUpTo 0 = 0
```

```
sumUpTo n = n + sumUpTo (n-1)
```

```
main = print (sumUpTo 3)
```

3. Click *Run*
4. The right pane should now show:

```
6
```

Alternatively, use the interpreter 'ghci'

1. Write your definitions in a file 'main.hs':

```
sumUpTo 0 = 0
```

```
sumUpTo n = n + sumUpTo (n-1)
```

2. Load your code with "ghci main.hs"

3. Execute your functions:

```
> sumUpTo 3
```

```
6
```

Small exercise

Update the example to compute $n! = n * (n - 1) * (n - 2) * .. * 1$ instead.

Recursion instead of iteration

Iteration = repeating a process a number of times

```
int sumUpTo(int n) {  
    int total = 0;  
    for (int i = n; n > 0; i--)  
        total += i;  
    return total;  
}
```

Recursion = defining something in terms of itself

sumUpTo 0 = 0

sumUpTo n = n + sumUpTo (n-1)

Pattern matching on values

A function is defined by a series of **equations**

- The value is compared with each left side until one “fits”
- In `sumUpTo`, if the value is zero we return zero, otherwise we fall to the second one

`sumUpTo 0 = 0`

`sumUpTo n = n + sumUpTo (n-1)`

Expressions instead of statements

What code does versus what code is

- Statements manipulate the **state** of the program
- Statements have an inherent **order**
- *Variables* name and store pieces of state

```
int sumUpTo(int n) {  
    int total = 0;  
    for (int i = n; n > 0; i--)  
        total += i;  
    return total;  
}
```

What code does versus what code is

- Value of a *whole expr.* depends only on its *subexpr.*
- Easier to compose and **reason** about
 - We will learn how to reason about programs

```
sumUpTo 3 --> 3 + sumUpTo 2
          --> 3 + 2 + sumUpTo 1
          --> ...
```

The factorial example:

Update the example to compute $n! = n * (n - 1) * (n - 2) * .. * 1$ instead.

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```
fac  :: Int -> Int
```

```
fac 0 = 1
```

```
fac n = n * fac (n-1)
```

The factorial example:

Update the example to compute $n! = n * (n - 1) * (n - 2) * .. * 1$ instead.

```
fac  :: Int -> Int
```

```
fac 0 = 1
```

```
fac n = n * fac (n-1)
```

- Each equation goes into its own line
- Equations are checked in order
 - If n is 0, then the function equals 1
 - If n is different from 0, then it goes to the second
- *Good style*: always write the type of your functions

Question

What happens if we write?

```
fac :: Int -> Int
```

```
fac n = n * fac (n-1)
```

```
fac 0 = 1
```

Functions as first-class citizens

Function = mapping of arguments to a result

```
greet name = "Hello, " ++ name ++ "!"
```

- Functions can be parameters of another function
- Functions can be returned from functions

```
> map greet ["Mary", "Joe"]  
["Hello, Mary!", "Hello, Joe!"]
```

map applies the function greet to each element of the list

Why Haskell?

Haskell can be defined with four adjectives

- Functional
- Statically typed
- Pure
- Lazy

Haskell is statically typed

- Every expression and function has a *type*
- The compiler *prevents* wrong combinations

```
> :t greet  -- Give me the type of greet
```

```
greet :: [Char] -> [Char]
```

```
> greet "Joe"
```

```
"Hello, Joe!"
```

```
> greet True
```

```
Couldn't match expected type '[Char]'  
      with actual type 'Bool'
```

Inference = if no type is given for an expression, the compiler *guesses* one

Haskell is pure

- You **cannot** use statement-based programming
 - Variables do not change, only give names
 - Program is easy to compose, understand and parallelize
- Functions which interact with the “outer world” are marked in their type with IO
 - This prevents unintended side-effects

```
readFile :: FilePath -> IO ()
```

We shall get to this one...

From a pedagogical standpoint

- Haskell *forces* a functional style
 - In contrast with imperative and OO languages
 - We can do *equational reasoning*
- Haskell teaches the value of static types
 - Compiler finds bugs long before run time
 - We can express really detailed invariants

How do I “run” Haskell?

- We are going to use GHC in this course
 - The (Glorious) **G**lasgow **H**askell **C**ompiler
 - State-of-the-art and open source
- Installing
 - Go to <https://www.haskell.org/ghcup>
 - Follow the installation instructions for installing 'ghcup' and 'ghc' on your OS.

Compiler versus interpreter

- Compiler (ghc)
 - Takes one or more files as an input
 - Generates a library or complete executable
 - There is **no interaction**
 - How you do things in *Imperatief/Mobiel/Gameprogrammeren*
- Interpreter (ghci)
 - **Interactive**, expressions are evaluated on-the-go
 - Useful for **testing** and **exploration**
 - You can also *load* a file
 - Almost as if you have typed in the entire file

GHC interpreter, ghci

1. Open a command line, terminal or console

2. Write `ghci` and press 

```
GHCi, version 9.14.1: http://www.haskell.org/ghc/  :? for help
Prelude>
```

3. Type an expression and press  to evaluate

```
Prelude> 2 + 3
5
Prelude>
```

4.  +  ( +  in Mac) or `:q`  to quit

```
Prelude> :q
Leaving GHCi.
```

First examples

```
> length [1, 2, 3]
```

```
3
```

```
> sum [1 .. 10]
```

```
55
```

```
> reverse [1 .. 10]
```

```
[10,9,8,7,6,5,4,3,2,1]
```

```
> replicate 10 3
```

```
[3,3,3,3,3,3,3,3,3,3]
```

```
> sum (replicate 10 3)
```

```
30
```

- Integer numbers appear as themselves
- `[1 .. 10]` creates a list from 1 to 10
- Functions are called (applied) **without** parentheses
 - In contrast to `replicate(10, 3)` in other languages

More about parentheses

- Parentheses delimit subexpressions
 - `sum (replicate 10 3)`: `sum` takes 1 parameter
 - `sum replicate 10 3`: `sum` takes 3 parameters

```
> sum replicate 10 3
```

```
<interactive>: error:
```

- Couldn't match type '[t0]' with 't1 -> t'
Expected type: `Int -> t0 -> t1 -> t`
Actual type: `Int -> t0 -> [t0]`

```
> sum (replicate 10 3)
```

```
30
```

First examples of types

```
> :t reverse
```

```
reverse :: [a] -> [a]
```

```
> :t replicate
```

```
replicate :: Int -> a -> [a]
```

- -> separates each argument and the result
- Int is the type of (machine) integers
- [Something] declares a list of Somethings
 - For example, [Int] is a list of integers
- [a] means list of *anything*
 - Note that a starts with a lowercase letter
 - a is called a *type variable*

Operators

```
> [1, 2] ++ [3, 4]
```

```
[1, 2, 3, 4]
```

```
> (++) [1, 2] [3, 4]
```

```
> :t (++)
```

```
(++) :: [a] -> [a] -> [a]
```

- Some names are completely made out of symbols
 - Think of +, *, &&, | |, ...
 - They are called **operators**
- Operators are used *between* the arguments
 - Anywhere else, you use parentheses

Question

What happens if we do?

```
> [1, 2] ++ [True, False]
```

Question

What happens if we do?

```
> [1, 2] ++ [True, False]
```

Type error!

Define a function in the interpreter

```
> let average ns = sum ns `div` length ns
> average [1,2,3]
2
> :t average
average :: Foldable t => t Int -> Int
```

- Functions are defined by one or more **equations**
- You turn a function into an operator with backticks
- Naming requirements
 - Function names must start with a lowercase
 - Arguments names too
- GHC has *inferred* a type for your function

Define a function in a file

You can write this definition in a file

```
average :: [Int] -> Int
average ns = sum ns `div` length ns
```

and then load it in the interpreter

```
> :load average.hs
[1 of 1] Compiling Main ( average.hs, interpreted )
> average [1,2,3]
2
```

or even work on it and then reload

```
> :r
[1 of 1] Compiling Main ( average.hs, interpreted )
```

More basic types

- Bool: True or False (note the uppercase!)
 - Usual operations like && (and), || (or) and not
 - Result of comparisons with ==, !=, <, ...
 - **Warning!** = defines, == compares

```
> 1 == 2 || 3 == 4
```

```
False
```

```
> 1 < 2 && 3 < 4
```

```
True
```

```
> nand x y = not (x && y)
```

```
> nand True False
```

```
True
```

More basic types

- Char: one single symbol
 - Written in *single* quotes: 'a', 'b', ...
- String: a sequence of characters
 - Written in *double* quotes: "hello"
 - They are simply [Char]
 - All list functions work for String

```
> ['a', 'b', 'c'] ++ ['d', 'e', 'f']
```

```
"abcdef"
```

```
> replicate 5 'a'
```

```
"aaaaa"
```

First example of higher-order function

```
> map fac [1 .. 5]
```

```
[1,2,6,24,120]
```

```
> map not [True, False, False]
```

```
[False,True,True]
```

```
> :t map
```

```
map :: (a -> b) -> [a] -> [b]
```

- map takes *two* arguments
 - The first argument is a function `a -> b`
 - The second argument is a list `[a]`
- map works for every pair of types `a` and `b` you choose
 - We say that map is *polymorphic*

Homework

1. Install GHC in your machine
2. Try out the examples
3. Basic exercises from the website.
4. Do Practical Assignment 0.

Three pieces of advice

1. Get yourself a good editor

- At the very least, with syntax highlighting
- Visual Studio Code and Atom are quite nice
 - Available at `code.visualstudio.com` and `atom.io`
 - Install Haskell syntax highlighting afterwards
- vi or Emacs for the adventurous

2. Get comfortable with the command line

- https://tutorial.djangogirls.org/en/intro_to_command_line/

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3. Go to the Instruction sessions !!!

- And do the pen-and-paper exercises !!!